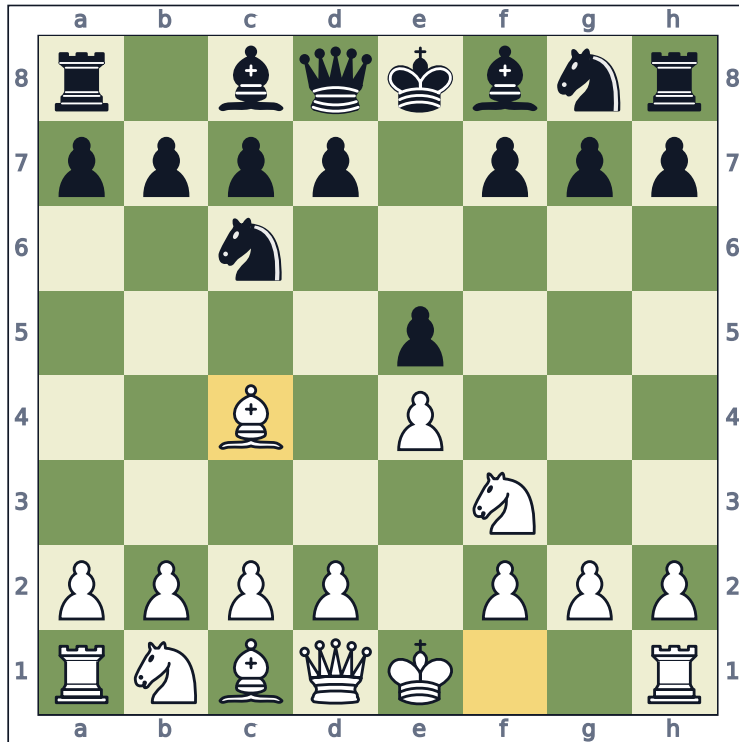


ITALIAN GAME, RUY LOPEZ, AND RELATED OPEN GAMES

Italian Game

ECO C50 | 22 named lines in this code



Featured opening position - gold marks the last move

IS IT A GOOD OPENING?

Good and fully playable. The position remains within a normal opening balance for both sides.

ENGINE SNAPSHOT

+0.00 for White. A shallow opening score is a guide, not a forced result.

GAME CHARACTER

Principled and instructive: development and central breaks lead naturally into the middlegame.

WHAT THIS OPENING IS

C50 covers Italian Game. White develops with pressure on e5 while Black builds a secure center and seeks the freeing ...d5 break. The diagram uses the featured line Italian Game.

DEFINING ROUTE

1. e4 e5 2. Nf3 Nc6 3. Bc4

UNDERSTAND THE POSITION

What both sides are trying to achieve

WHITE'S GOALS

Castle, prepare d4, improve the least active piece, and preserve pressure rather than forcing tactics that are not ready.

BLACK'S GOALS

Defend e5 efficiently, challenge the center with ...d5, and use queenside or kingside activity according to White's structure.

PAWN BREAKS - THE ENGINE OF THE OPENING

d4 and ...d5 define most transformations. c3 often supports d4; ...c5 may challenge a closed center.

PIECE MAP

The bishops on c4/b5 and c5/b4 shape development. Rooks become active on e- and d-files after central exchanges. The central pawn placement should decide where each bishop and knight belongs.

WHAT USUALLY GOES WRONG

The position can look quiet while tactical pressure accumulates on e5, f7, and along central files. Recheck the center after every opponent deviation; opening names do not make moves automatic.

POSITION SNAPSHOT

Black moves next. Material is level. Central markers: White pawn on e4, Black pawn on e5.

WHO SHOULD STUDY IT?

Elite, fully sound opening territory. It rewards patient improvement as much as concrete calculation.

COMPLETE CODE CONTENTS

Every named C50 line

This section preserves all 22 names and defining routes assigned to C50 in the source catalogue. Different move orders can reach the same position; learn the structures and goals before memorizing labels.

001 Four Knights Game: Italian Variation

1. e4 e5 2. Nf3 Nc6 3. Bc4 Bc5 4. Nc3 Nf6

002 Italian Game

1. e4 e5 2. Nf3 Nc6 3. Bc4

003 Italian Game: Anti-Fried Liver Defense

1. e4 e5 2. Nf3 Nc6 3. Bc4 h6

004 Italian Game: Blackburne-Kostić Gambit

1. e4 e5 2. Nf3 Nc6 3. Bc4 Nd4

005 Italian Game: Classical Variation, Albin Gambit

1. e4 e5 2. Nf3 Nc6 3. Bc4 Bc5 4. O-O Nf6 5. c3

006 Italian Game: Deutz Gambit

1. e4 e5 2. Nf3 Nc6 3. Bc4 Bc5 4. O-O Nf6 5. d4

007 Italian Game: Giuoco Pianissimo

1. e4 e5 2. Nf3 Nc6 3. Bc4 Bc5 4. d3

008 Italian Game: Giuoco Pianissimo

1. e4 e5 2. Nf3 Nc6 3. Bc4 Bc5 4. Nc3 Nf6 5. O-O O-O

009 Italian Game: Giuoco Pianissimo

1. e4 e5 2. Nf3 Nc6 3. Bc4 Bc5 4. Nc3 Nf6 5. O-O O-O 6. d3

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010 **Italian Game: Giuoco Pianissimo**
1. e4 e5 2. Nf3 Nc6 3. Bc4 Nf6 4. O-O Bc5 5. Nc3 d6 6. d3

011 **Italian Game: Giuoco Pianissimo, Canal Variation**
1. e4 e5 2. Nf3 Nc6 3. Bc4 Bc5 4. d3 Nf6 5. Nc3 d6 6. Bg5

012 **Italian Game: Giuoco Pianissimo, Dubois Variation**
1. e4 e5 2. Nf3 Nc6 3. Bc4 Bc5 4. d3 f5 5. Ng5 f4

013 **Italian Game: Giuoco Pianissimo, Italian Four Knights Variation**
1. e4 e5 2. Nf3 Nc6 3. Bc4 Bc5 4. d3 Nf6 5. Nc3

014 **Italian Game: Giuoco Pianissimo, Lucchini Gambit**
1. e4 e5 2. Nf3 Nc6 3. Bc4 Bc5 4. d3 f5

015 **Italian Game: Giuoco Pianissimo, Normal**
1. e4 e5 2. Nf3 Nc6 3. Bc4 Nf6 4. d3 Bc5

016 **Italian Game: Giuoco Piano**
1. e4 e5 2. Nf3 Nc6 3. Bc4 Bc5

017 **Italian Game: Hungarian Defense**
1. e4 e5 2. Nf3 Nc6 3. Bc4 Be7

018 **Italian Game: Hungarian Defense, Tartakower Variation**
1. e4 e5 2. Nf3 Nc6 3. Bc4 Be7 4. d4 exd4 5. c3 Nf6 6. e5 Ne4

COMPLETE CODE CONTENTS

Every named C50 line

This section preserves all 22 names and defining routes assigned to C50 in the source catalogue. Different move orders can reach the same position; learn the structures and goals before memorizing labels.

019 **Italian Game: Jerome Gambit**
1. e4 e5 2. Nf3 Nc6 3. Bc4 Bc5 4. Bxf7+

020 **Italian Game: Paris Defense**
1. e4 e5 2. Nf3 Nc6 3. Bc4 d6

021 **Italian Game: Rosentreter Gambit**
1. e4 e5 2. Nf3 Nc6 3. Bc4 Bc5 4. d4

022 **Italian Game: Rousseau Gambit**
1. e4 e5 2. Nf3 Nc6 3. Bc4 f5